
Using Computer Games to Salvage Thought Experiments in Ethics

Presentation for PHIL 216, instructed by Hülya Şimga & Nalan Saraç

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The Trolley Problem:



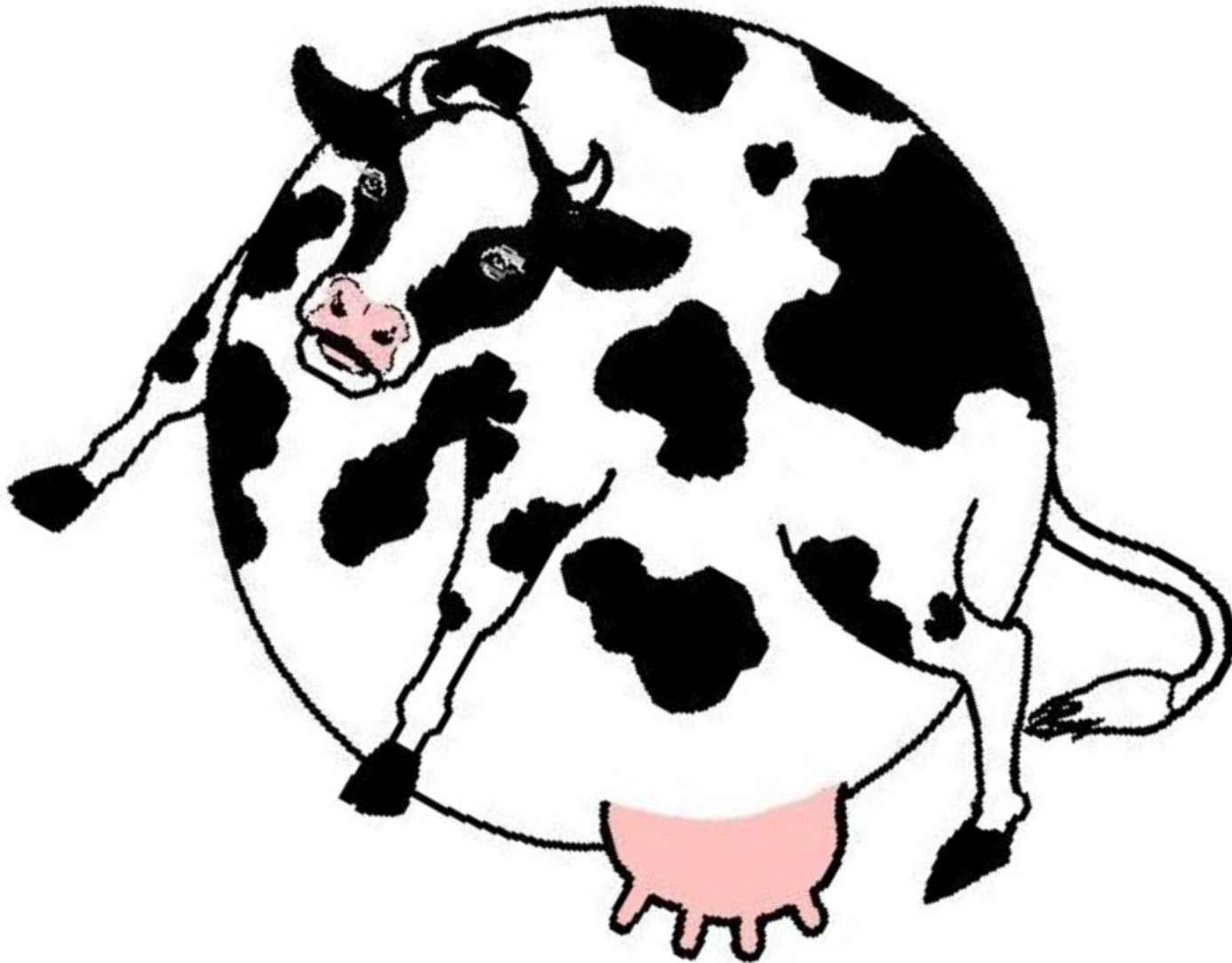
Variations:

- (Rockslide) “We might, for example, imagine a case in which we redirect a trolley in such a way that it stopped far away from Joe [the lonely worker], but its movement started a rockslide, a threat that did not previously exist, which killed Joe.” [Kam89, p. 228]
- (Grenade) “[S]uppose that the only way to stop the trolley is to throw a grenade which will stop it, but we foresee that pieces of the grenade will also hit and kill Joe, an innocent bystander, whose death will play no causal role in saving the five.” [Kam89, p. 230]



The Problems with the Trolley Problem:

- (I) Problem of Efficient Isolation
- (II) Problem of Temporal Urgency



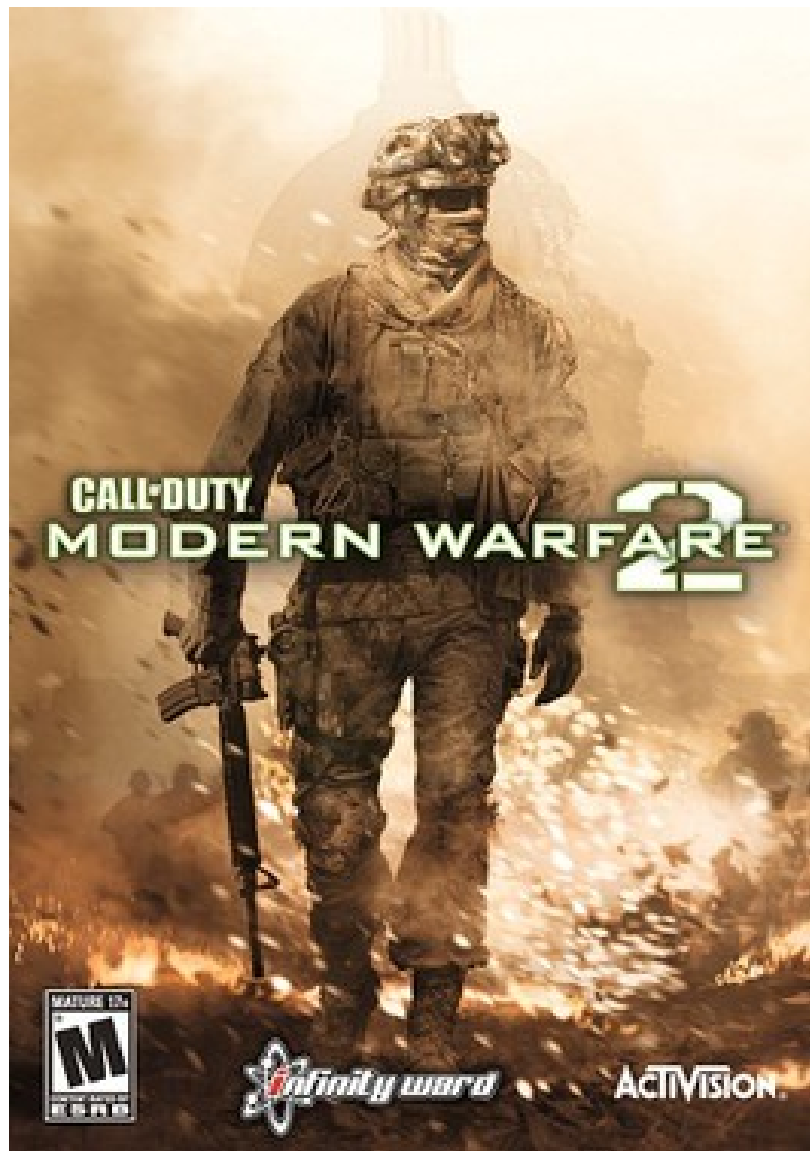
Solution:

- Invoke a ludic (gameplay) possibility instead of a physical possibility.
- “[A]bstraction can be seen as the process by which any given subject matter is transformed into game form.”
[Juu07]
- “Any object can be designed with a value system in mind, [...] those values can be imprinted in the very design of the object, permeating then to the experience of that artifact. Computer games are designed objects; therefore they can be moral objects.” [Sic05, p. 4]



Call of Duty: Modern Warfare 2:

Mission 4: "No Russian"



Papers, Please:



Glory to Arstotzka.

NEXT

Papers, Please:

END OF
DAY 21

8
CLASS

The day was cut short by a terrorist attack.
Your sister has been arrested. Her young daughter needs a home.
A class-7 apartment is available. (Rent = 30, Heat = 10)



x1

SPACE

TAB



SAVINGS	130	
SALARY (4)	20	
PENALTIES (1)	-5	
BRIBES	15	
RENT	-25	
FOOD	-5	⦿
HEAT	-10	⦿
SHARPSHOOTER BONUS	20	
ADOPT NIECE	-40	○
MOVE TO CLASS-7	-100	○

\$140

OK

Wife

DEAD

Son

DEAD

Mother-in-law

DEAD

Uncle

SLEEP



That's all Folks!

Bibliography:

- [Foo67] Foot, Philippa. "The Problem of Abortion and the Doctrine of the Double Effect". *Oxford Review*, No. 5. 1967.
<http://philpapers.org/rec/FOOTPO-2>
- [Juu07] Juul, Jesper. "A Certain Level Of Abstraction". *Proceedings of the 2007 DiGRA International Conference: Situated Play*. The University of Tokyo. 2007.
<http://www.digra.org/wp-content/uploads/digital-library/07312.29390.pdf>
- [Kam89] Kamm, F.M.. "Harming Some to Save Others". *Philosophical Studies: An International Journal for Philosophy in the Analytic Tradition*, Vol. 57, No. 3. 1989. pp. 227-260.
- [PaPl] "Timeline". *Papers, Please Wiki*. 2016.
<http://papersplease.wikia.com/wiki/Timeline>
- [NoRu] "No Russian". *Call of Duty Wiki*. 2016.
http://callofduty.wikia.com/wiki/No_Russian
- [Sic05] Sicart, Miguel. "The Ethics of Computer Game Design". "The Ethics of Computer Game Design". *Proceedings of DiGRA 2005 International Conference: Changing Views: Worlds in Play*. 2005.
<http://www.digra.org/wp-content/uploads/digital-library/06276.55524.pdf>
- [Zag09] Zagal, José P.. "Ethically Notable Videogames: Moral Dilemmas and Gameplay". *Proceedings of DiGRA 2009: Breaking New Ground: Innovation in Games, Play, Practice and Theory*. Brunel University. 2009.
<http://www.digra.org/wp-content/uploads/digital-library/09287.13336.pdf>

Ludography:

- Infinity Ward. *Call of Duty: Modern Warfare 2*. Activision. 2009.
- Pope, Lucas. *Papers, Please*. 3909. 2013.

Videos:

- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2UadzYlwors>
- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_QP5X6fcukM

Images:

- http://imgs.xkcd.com/comics/trolley_problem.png
- <http://s2.quickmeme.com/img/ba/bae9b0777c196abea46bb30297fc2a7a15e4bba1da11a4c17c85c2169d7376>
- http://orig06.deviantart.net/86fe/f/2012/263/d/6/spherical_cow_by_flrmptrix-d5fdjc9.jpg
- http://pre05.deviantart.net/7f20/th/pre/i/2014/147/1/d/chibi_jigsaw_by_sew_what-d7jzv5o.jpg
- https://upload.wikimedia.org/wikipedia/en/d/db/Modern_Warfare_2_cover.PNG
- http://vignette2.wikia.nocookie.net/callofduty/images/8/82/No_Russian_menu_image_MW2.png/revision/latest
- <http://test.greenlitgaming.com/wp-content/uploads/2013/05/Papers-Please-title-screen.png>
- <https://www.graphite.org/sites/default/files/experience-media-file/paperspleasegame3.png>
- <http://wallpapercave.com/wp/Enn7s33.jpg>
- <https://i.ytimg.com/vi/5et9ADk4EYs/maxresdefault.jpg>